



DevTalk

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#EducarCura



Advocating for Change: CSOs Demand Comprehensive Sexual Harassment Prevention and Remedy Law

Educo Bangladesh, NGCAF Parliamentary Caucus on Child Rights (PCCR), and Plan International Bangladesh came together to demand action on sexual harassment prevention and remedy. On December 13, they organised a discussion meeting with members of the Caucus to enact the proposed "Comprehensive Sexual Harassment Prevention and Remedy Law."

The meeting was a resounding success, with a draft comprehensive act presented for feedback and reviewed by the Parliamentary legislative Department. The Honorable Deputy Speaker

was the Chief Guest, and many other influential individuals were in attendance, including members of PCCR, advocates, Justice from Dhaka district court, Additional Secretary from Ministry of Women and Children Affairs, Additional DIG of police, and Joint Secretary from Parliament.

The meeting was a powerful call to action, with strong commitments from the Honorable Deputy Speaker to take necessary steps to place the Bill in Parliament. It was an evidence to the power of advocacy and collaboration in creating positive change.



A Consultative Workshop with Tea Garden Management for Sustainable Impact under ALOY ALOW Project

In October 2022, a consultative workshop was held at the Grand Sultan Tea Resort, Sreemangal, where 30 Tea Garden managements and concerned government departments (Department of Labour, Department of Welfare Trust of Tea Labour under Tea Board) came together to discuss the project's outcomes and reflect on its sustainability. The event was an excellent success, with participants applauding the project's close collaboration and

tangible impact. Moreover, with the enthusiastic support of the chief guest, Mr. Sheikh Qamrul Hasan, Controller and Deputy Secretary of the state, Tea Labor welfare fund, (CSBT), it's clear that the ALOY ALOW project is poised to spread its tea-rrific benefits to even more tea gardens in the future. So, let us keep the momentum going and see what amazing things we can achieve together!

Educo Bangladesh Secures Funding from Institutional and Private Donors

Educo Bangladesh ends the year 2022 with new partnerships with both institutional and private donors such as KOICA and MANGO. KOICA (Korea International Cooperation Agency) has funded the "Strengthening right to education for child labourer in Dhaka city" intervention proposed by Educo Bangladesh in partnership with implementing partner, ESDO. The project aims at strengthening the right to education of working children in Dhaka city in a period of three years. Educo Bangladesh also

secured funding from MANGO, a Spanish corporate donor, to fund the one-year intervention "Promote Quality Education in Mainstream Government Primary Schools". The project is being implemented in partnership with Nari Maitree and POPI.

In addition to this, we have also formed a consortium with Christian Aid and Relief International to pursue further funding opportunities in an integrated approach."



Partners Meet 2022: Celebrating Achievements, Building a Brighter Future Together

Educo Bangladesh's annual Partners Meet was a day full of excitement and engagement. The event took place on 18 December 2022, and brought together Executive Directors, PC and Focal Person of partner organisations, and Educo Bangladesh colleagues.

Throughout the day, we and our eight partner organisations shared our achievements, obstacles, and learning, as well as potential areas for improvement in the programme and partnership. It was a participatory and collaborative environment, with great debates and discussions that left everyone feeling more connected.

The Country Director, Director of Programmes, Head of Finance and Administration, and other Educo colleagues were also present to provide their expectations and suggestions. The day was a evidence to the power of partnerships and our shared commitment to making a positive impact in Bangladesh.

Before the meeting ended, we signed MoU with seven partners for five internally funded projects for 2023-2025. It was an exciting moment that reinforced our collective determination to build a brighter future together.



Joining Forces Bangladesh (JFB): Urging the Establishment of a Separate Child Directorate in Bangladesh

Educo Bangladesh and Joining Forces Bangladesh (JFB) is a coalition of six child-focused international organisations working to establish the rights of children reflected in the SDGs and UNCRC. On 20 November 2022, they conducted a Media Dialogue with The Daily Ittefaq on “How long to wait to get a separate child directorate.”

The establishment of a separate directorate for children has been a long-standing issue for the child rights community in Bangladesh, and JFB has been at the forefront of lobbying

for it. The event was a call to action, urging the government to prioritise the establishment of a separate child directorate and ensure that the rights of children are protected and promoted.

The Chairman of the Parliamentary Standing Committee for MOWCA and the Co-Chairperson of PCCR were the Chief Guest and special guest of the programme, respectively, and committed to working with JFB for the establishment of a separate child directorate. It was a powerful moment of collaboration and advocacy for the rights of children in Bangladesh.

Scoring Goals for a Better Future: A youth football tournament at Aloy Alow project youth

During August-September 2022, the ALOY-ALOW project of Educo Bangladesh kicked off a thrilling football tournament that brought together 480 young athletes aged 11-24 from 32 youth clubs in Tea Garden & Hoar areas of Moulvibazar district. The competition

was not just about the sport, but also about spreading awareness on crucial issues such as drug prevention, child rights, and ending child marriage. After intense inter-club competitions, the winning teams faced off in the semi-finals and finals at the upazila level. In the end, the Mritinga adolescent and youth club of Prochesta emerged as champions! MSED A played a crucial role in making the tournament a success, with their strong local links and influence.

The final match was graced by the Upazilla Nirbahi officer of Sreemangal and the Country Director of Educo Bangladesh, among other esteemed guests. The tournament showcased the immense talent of young footballers from these communities and Educo Bangladesh pledged to continue supporting their overall development.



Educo Bangladesh's 'Our Champions' Book Honors Remarkable Community Contributors

In the remote tea gardens and hoar areas of Bangladesh, there are unsung heroes who have been tirelessly working towards the betterment of children. These individuals have faced numerous challenges and obstacles, yet their love, labor, and leadership have shone brightly, bringing hope and light to their communities.

Educo Bangladesh recognised these champions through their 'ALOY ALOW' project, publishing a book titled 'Our Champions'. The book highlights the remarkable efforts of these unsung heroes, who have gone above and beyond to take the project forward and increase its reputation.

Through this publication, Educo Bangladesh has shown that recognition is an essential component of development, inspiring others to feel connected to the initiatives and continue their involvement. Eight individuals from different fields have been selected as champions, acknowledging their efforts in contributing towards the well-being of children.

Farzana Khan, Director of programmes, Educo Bangladesh launched the book in October, stating that all contributors to the project are champions. This unique initiative celebrates the tireless efforts of these unsung heroes and reinforces the importance of acknowledging and appreciating those who work towards making the world a better place.

Empowering Mobility: Educo Bangladesh Distributes Assistive Devices to Disabled Community Members in Cox's Bazar

In Cox's Bazar, Educo Bangladesh is making a difference by empowering members of the community with disabilities. In December, an assistive devices distribution event was held in coordination and collaboration with the Union and Upazila administration, where 17 wheelchairs were distributed to selected disabled individuals in the host community at Eidgah union, Ukhiya.

Thanks to the Support to Community-Based Education and Protection for the Children of Rohingya Camp and Host-Community in Cox's Bazar project, funded by ChildFund Korea, these individuals can now access greater mobility and independence.

Upazila Nirbahi Officer presented to hand over the devices to their new owners which will expand them more flexibility. This is just one example of the incredible impact that Educo Bangladesh is having on the lives of those in need and continue to make a positive difference in the community.

Educo Bangladesh Empowers School Communities with Training on Protection Mechanisms

Ensuring a protective school environment is vital for promoting quality education. That's why a special training on Protection Mechanism was organised in Dhaka, Thakurgaon, and Mymensingh, with the participation of 93 Head Teachers and 80 SMC presidents, as well as SMC members of Govt. Primary schools in October. This exciting initiative was organised by Educo partners, Nari Maitree, Eco-Social Development Organization (ESDO), and People's Oriented Program Implementation (POPI), with the support of UNO, Upazila/Thana Education Officers, and other stakeholders as resource persons.

The training equipped participants with the skills and knowledge to identify and respond to potential risks and threats, ensuring a safer and more secure learning environment for all students.



Educo Bangladesh Hosts Leadership and School Management Training for SMCs and Head Teachers

Educo Bangladesh, in collaboration with its partners, recently organised a series of Training in October on Leadership and School Management workshops in Dhaka, Thakurgaon, and Mymensingh. The aim was to increase the capacity of School Management Committees (SMCs) and enhance the quality of education in government primary schools. With a total of 138 Head Teachers and SMC members in attendance, in collaborating with Nari Maitree, Eco-Social Development Organization (ESDO), and People's Oriented Program Implementation (POPI), Educo ensured that UNOs, Upazila/Thana Education Officers, and other stakeholders were actively involved as resource persons.

Thus, the result of the training programme was not only increased the skills of the SMC members but also ensured that teachers and learners were provided with a safe and joyful learning environment.



Workshop on “Balancing the Feminine and Masculine Traits to be a Better Human Being”

For building an inclusive and gender-responsive working environment with the integration of gender transformative approaches and instilling it in the organisational structure, the Educo Bangladesh Gender Committee has organised two day-long workshops on “Balancing the Feminine and Masculine Traits to be a Better Human Being” in September 2022 in three districts Dhaka, Moulvibazar and Cox’s Bazar respectively. 66 employees of Educo Bangladesh, 32 employees of partners participated in the workshop.

The key objectives of the workshop were to grow a common understanding of human traits and its implications on day-to-day lives, gain a general understating to challenge the stereotypical gender roles to advance gender equality in our personal and professional lives, and initiate thoughts for dismantling implicit biases and breaking the vicious circles of the culture of impunity. This workshop accepted methodology like Drama, Lecture, Group work, Presentation, Meditation, and Debate to make it more interactive with the joyful participation of all Educo employees.



How Youth's Passion Saved Feathered Friends



Sahirul's story serves as an inspiration to all of us. It shows that with a little effort and determination, we can make a positive impact on the world around us. The bird sanctuary provides a safe haven for birds in addition to serving as a reminder of the importance of preserving our environment for future generations.

Sahirul, an Educo Adolescents and Youth Club (AYC) member, observed a steady decline in the number of birds in his community. The removal of trees and other human activities were destroying many of their natural habitats. At that time, AYC had their annual planning workshop in association with ESDO, where many innovative ideas were discussed, including the bird sanctuary. They were so excited that they wanted to build a bird sanctuary in a huge tree where many birds could live peacefully. Then they bought mud pots for setting up birdhouses that can cater to various bird species.

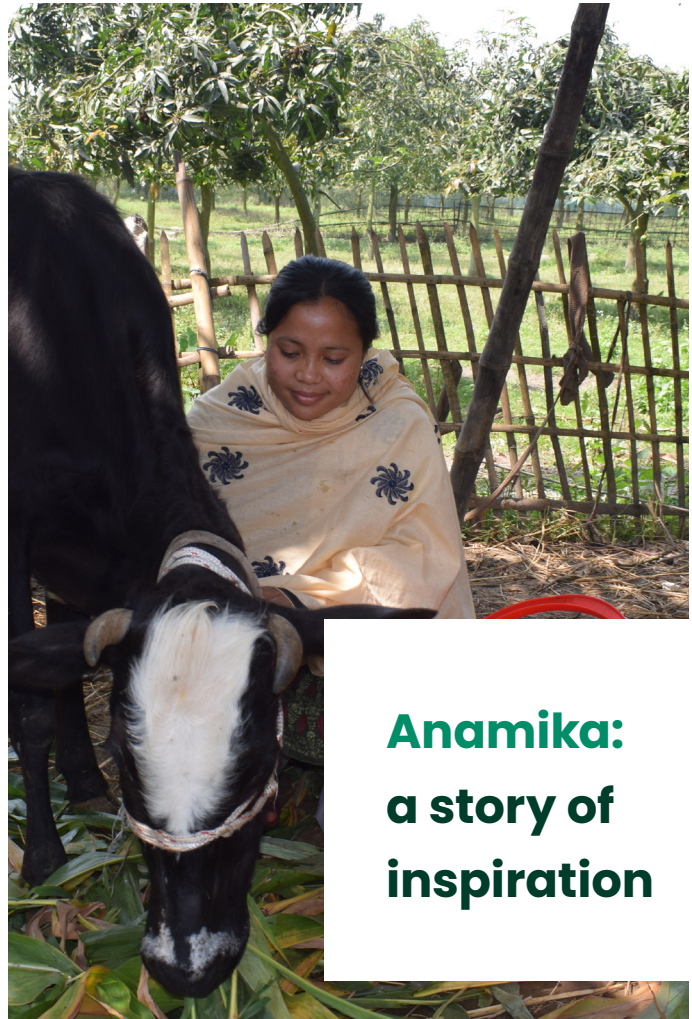


This youth group not only dreams of organising events to educate people about the importance of protecting birds and their habitats but also hopes that the bird sanctuary will be a popular spot for bird watchers and nature enthusiasts. They even started campaigns to raise awareness about the dangers of littering and the impact it has on the environment.

Their hard work paid off, and soon the bird sanctuary was home to various bird species, including endangered ones. AYC members felt a great sense of satisfaction knowing that they had made a difference in the lives of these beautiful creatures.

Moo-ving Forward: Anamika's Journey as a Successful Dairy Entrepreneur

Anamika, a 24-year-old entrepreneur, has the passion to work independently. Few years back, she started a new journey by investing in a farm, and over the years, her dream has grown bigger. She not only makes profit with this, but also cares about animal welfare and shows concern that her animals are well cared for. So, she ensures that her animals are fed nutritious food and are given regular health checkups. With the support of ESDO, Educo's partner, she has implemented various farming



**Anamika:
a story of
inspiration**



**She dreams
of selling her
products
online, which
will help
her reach
a wider
audience.**

techniques to improve the quality and quantity of milk produced by her livestock. Moreover, she secured a loan from the government for efficiently managing her ventures.

The dairy products of her farm have gained popularity in the local market due to their high quality and freshness. Anamika's success as an entrepreneur has inspired many other young women in her village to take up farming as a career.



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